

HS 213: Japanese Language Class II

Course Code	HS 213
Course Name	Japanese Language Class II
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	Those who have completed Level 1 or are recognized as having equivalent ability
Intended for	UG/PG/Ph.D
Approval	62nd BoA (Jan 2026)

Preamble

Building upon the foundational knowledge from the course “Japanese Language Class I”, this course is designed to elevate students’ Japanese skills of reading, listening, writing, and speaking comprehensively.

After taking this course, students will be able to

- Expand vocabulary and kanji knowledge: Learn commonly used JLPT N5 and N4 level words and approximately 60 new kanji characters, enabling them to read and comprehend everyday texts and interact on a wider range of content.
- Deepen understanding of grammar: Learn more complex sentence structures to understand and express themselves in a wider range of situations, such as basic personal and family information, shopping, and work.
- Enhance conversational fluency: Engage in role-play scenarios and interactive dialogues to improve speaking and listening skills in practical contexts.
- Develop a deep insight into Japanese culture: Explore the cultural nuances of Japanese society, including etiquette, traditions, and contemporary practices, to gain a deeper appreciation of the language’s cultural roots.

Course Modules

Classes are conducted according to the textbook ‘Marugoto (Starter A1)’ and ‘Marugoto (Elementary1 A2)’. Marugoto focuses on communication using Japanese and consists of scene syllabus. It systematically introduces the sentence patterns, grammar, vocabulary and kanji step by step showing every situation where these things are actually used.

Each lesson provides opportunities to read sentences, understand grammar, practice pronunciation, solve listening comprehension questions and write sentences in Japanese.

About 60 kanji characters are introduced, and a worksheet is provided separately in class to give students the opportunity to practice writing them.

The course also includes a number of questions that offer an opportunity to understand Japanese culture and can be discussed with learners in class.

The textbook Minna no Nihongo and its supplementary materials are also used as part of the main textbook as appropriate.

Homework assignments are given as appropriate to supplement the study content.

[Time of lectures]

- The first lesson is Introduction. (1 hour)
- The second class will review the Beginner Course. (1 hour)
- Lower-Intermediate Course covers Lesson 13 to Lesson 18 of the textbook ‘Marugoto (Starter A1)’, and Lessons 1 to 6 of ‘Marugoto (Elementary1 A2)’.
- Each lesson is scheduled for three hours. (36 hours in total)
- Exams (or assignments) are given in the middle and at the end of the semester. (4 hours in total)

(Total of 42 hours planned.)

[Title and Contents of lectures]

Marugoto (Starter A1)

- **Lesson 1 – How are you going to get there?:** Recognize station and taxi signs
- **Lesson 2 – It's a famous temple:** Say how to get to a destination
- **Lesson 3 – Cute!:** Talk about what you want to buy
- **Lesson 4 – I'll take this:** Make a brief comment on things in a shop
- **Lesson 5 – It was fun:** Say what you did on your days off
- **Lesson 6 – I would like to visit Kyoto next time:** Say where you want to go next time

Marugoto (Elementary1 A2)

- **Lesson 1 – We live in Tokyo:** Talk briefly about where you/your family live and what you/they do
- **Lesson 2 – My hobby is listening to classical music:** Talk about your hobbies
- **Lesson 3 – It's spring now in Japan:** Talk about the change of seasons
- **Lesson 4 – It's a nice day, isn't it?:** Greet people by talking about the weather
- **Lesson 5 – This park is big and beautiful:** Tell a friend what a place he/she is interested in is like and what to be careful about, using a map
- **Lesson 6 – Please go straight:** Correct some information misunderstood by someone

Text Books

1. The Japan Foundation, *MARUGOTO: Japanese language and culture Starter A1 Coursebook for communicative language competences*, SANSYUSYA, Japan, 2013
2. The Japan Foundation, *MARUGOTO: Japanese language and culture Elementary1 A2 Coursebook for communicative language competences*, SANSYUSYA, Japan, 2014
3. 3A corporation, *Minna no Nihongo Elementary*, 3A corporation, Japan, 2012

References

1. Atusko Tokui, *Tabunka kyousei no Komyunike-shon: Nihongo kyouiku no genba kara*, ALC Publishing, Japan, 2020
2. Are Hajikano, *JLPT N5 Listening Comprehension Points & Practice*, 3A network, Japan, 2022
3. Arc academy, *Hajimete No Nihongo Nouryoku Shiken N4 Tango 1500 (English/ Vietnamese Edition)*, ASK Publishing, Japan, 2016
4. Arc academy, *Hajimete No Nihongo Nouryoku Shiken N5 Tango 1000 (English/ Vietnamese Edition)*, ASK Publishing, Japan, 2017
5. Atusko Tokui, *Tabunka kyousei no Komyunike-shon: Nihongo kyouiku no genba kara*, ALC Publishing, Japan, 2020
6. Erin Meyer, *THE CULTURE MAP*, Public Affairs, US, 2016
7. Kiyomi Ogawa, Orrin Cummins, *YASANICHI MANGA JAPAN GUIDE*, IBC Publishing, Japan, 2022
8. Kyoko Igarashi, *The Best Complete Workbook for the Japanese-Language Proficiency Test N5 – Language Knowledge (Vocabulary/Grammar), Reading & Listening*, The Japan Times Publishing, Japan, 2022
9. Noriko Kobayashi, *Mastering Japanese by Ear*, Bonjinsha, Japan, 2024
10. Tsuchiya Haruhito, *Customs of Japan*, IBC Publishing, Japan, 2023
11. The Japan Foundation, *IRODORI-Japanese for Life in Japan-*, The Japan Foundation, Japan, 2020
12. Yoji Yamakuse, Michael A. Coony, *Heart & Soul of the Japanese*, IBC Publishing, Japan, 2023
13. Yukiko Ogata, *Nihongo Fun & Easy: Survival Japanese Conversation for Beginners*, ASK Publishing, Japan, 2009